



Fielders need to be prepared for quick reactions and rapid sprints. For ODIs, while the intensity is slightly lower than in T20s, the emphasis is on maintaining consistency over a longer period. Fielders need to be versatile, often switching between saving singles and cutting off boundaries. In Test cricket, the requirements shift significantly. Fielders need to display a high level of concentration and patience, as the game can stretch over days. The physical and mental endurance to stay focused for long periods is crucial.

Talking of athletic ability, we've seen some incredible boundary catches in the World Cup. What is the key to being a good boundary rider?

Firstly, athleticism is paramount. But being a great boundary rider goes beyond just physical attributes. Rope awareness is crucial — knowing exactly where you are in relation to the boundary rope can make the difference between saving runs and conceding them. Anticipating the batter's tendencies is another key aspect, as it allows the fielder to position themselves strategically. Finally, understanding

the density of the air and how it affects the ball's travel is key. In different conditions, it may travel faster or slower through the air.

What makes someone like Jadeja such a good fielder?

His speed, anticipation, and ability to react quickly are remarkable, allowing him to cover ground and respond instantly to the ball. His natural athleticism gives him the foundation to excel in various fielding positions, whether inside the circle or patrolling the boundary. Moreover, Jadeja's throwing arm is a significant asset. He has one of the most powerful and accurate arms in the game, capable of hitting the stumps from almost any position on the field.

How much have throwing and diving techniques evolved over the last five years?

These techniques have evolved a lot, and credit goes to the incredible improvement in ground conditions, especially here in India. The BCCI has done a fantastic job ensuring that our grounds are maintained to the highest standards, which allows players to execute these skills with greater confidence. These

advancements aren't just about the techniques but also about the overall fitness and strength that our players have built over the years. When you slide and dive, you're creating opportunities to make an impact, whether it's turning a single into a run-out chance or stopping a boundary that could shift momentum.

Can cricketers make significant improvements after a certain stage?

I believe that while natural athleticism might peak at a younger age, the experience and game awareness that come with age can actually enhance a fielder's effectiveness. We've seen senior players continue to set high standards in the field because they understand the importance of positioning, angles, and quick decision-making. Additionally, those who played multiple sports in their younger years often develop a broader range of cognitive skills.

Is a fielder's position determined according to the batsman at the crease?

This decision is influenced by detailed analysis and understanding of the batsman's strengths, weaknesses, and playing tendencies. For instance, if a batsman is known for playing certain shots frequently, like cover drives or sweeps, fielders are positioned strategically to counter it. For example, while one player may play the cover drive square of the wicket, another might tend to play it finer. The fielder's position is adjusted accordingly to anticipate and cut off potential scoring areas.

Is there any area that Indian fielders need to improve in?

Fielding is a critical aspect that requires constant attention. In any team, the goal is always to seek continuous improvement. Our team believes in maintaining high standards and constantly evolving. Every match and practice session is an opportunity to learn and get better.